

# Timefold Series A Investment Report

*\$13M raised, led by Alstin Capital — deal summary, sources, and the investment narrative Timefold used to close the round*

## Deal snapshot

|                            |                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Round                      | Series A                                                                                                  |
| Amount raised              | \$13,000,000 (USD)                                                                                        |
| Announced                  | June 23, 2026                                                                                             |
| Lead investor              | Alstin Capital                                                                                            |
| Co-investor (new)          | Kompas VC                                                                                                 |
| Returning investors        | Lakestar, Smartfin                                                                                        |
| Prior round                | €6M (Sept 2024), led by Lakestar with Smartfin — total disclosed raise now ~\$13M + €6M across two rounds |
| Company / HQ               | Timefold BV — Ghent, Belgium                                                                              |
| CEO / CTO                  | Maarten Vandenbroucke (CEO) · Geoffrey De Smet (CTO, creator of OptaPlanner)                              |
| Stated use of funds        | Accelerate US expansion; scale platform product development                                               |
| Reported traction          | Annual recurring revenue grew 4x in 2025                                                                  |
| Named enterprise customers | NEC Software Solutions, CBRE, Orange Telecom, ADP, Lufthansa, Thales, Subaru, Palantir, Deutsche Bahn     |

## Sources — click through for the original coverage

Every figure and quote in this report traces back to one of the public sources below.

- [Timefold — official press release: "Timefold Raises \\$13M as AI Drives Demand for Routing and Scheduling APIs"](#)
- [Tech.eu — "Timefold raises \\$13M Series A to scale scheduling optimisation infrastructure"](#)
- [FinSMEs — "Timefold Raises \\$13M in Series A Funding"](#)
- [The SaaS News — "Timefold Raises \\$13M Series A"](#)
- [Smartfin \(investor\) — "Timefold Raises \\$13M as AI Drives Demand for Routing and Scheduling APIs"](#)
- [Pulse2 — "Timefold Raises \\$13 Million Series A To Expand Routing And Scheduling APIs"](#)
- [Dealroom.co — "Timefold raises \\$13M Series A to scale its planning-optimisation APIs"](#)
- [Cresco Law — "Cresco advised Timefold on its \\$13M Series A funding round" \(legal counsel confirmation\)](#)

- [Startbase — "Timefold Raises \\$13 Million"](#)
- [PitchBook — Timefold company profile \(valuation, cap table, investor history\)](#)
- [Tracxn — Timefold company profile \(funding history, competitors\)](#)
- [Tech.eu — prior round: "Belgian startup Timefold raises €6M for planning optimisation platform" \(Sept 2024\)](#)
- [Alstin Capital \(lead investor, new\)](#)
- [Kompas VC \(co-investor, new\)](#)
- [Lakestar \(returning investor\)](#)
- [Smartfin \(returning investor\)](#)
- [Timefold pricing page \(product/tier reference\)](#)

## What the money is for

Timefold has now raised roughly \$13M in this Series A on top of a €6M round closed in September 2024 (Lakestar-led, with Smartfin). Per the company's own release and matching coverage across Tech.eu, FinSMEs, and Dealroom, the new capital is earmarked for two things: accelerating US market expansion, and continued platform product development to meet enterprise demand for embeddable scheduling optimization infrastructure.

The round is notable for who returned: both Lakestar and Smartfin backed the 2024 seed and came back for this round, while Alstin Capital stepped in as new lead and Kompas VC joined as a new co-investor — a pattern that reads as existing investors doubling down alongside a new lead who priced and led the round.

## Momentum the company pointed to

- Annual recurring revenue grew 4x in 2025, driven by enterprises and software vendors embedding Timefold's APIs into mission-critical field service and workforce management workflows.
- A global real estate services company (unnamed) reduced drive time by up to 33%, cut distance traveled by 43%, and eliminated overtime entirely using Timefold's Field Service Routing product.
- A major US retail staffing provider (unnamed) cut a scheduling process from 10 weeks to 10 minutes using Timefold's Employee Shift Scheduling model.
- Enterprise logos cited across the announcement and prior coverage: NEC Software Solutions (NECSWS), CBRE, Orange Telecom, ADP, Lufthansa, Thales, Subaru, Palantir, and Deutsche Bahn.

## The pitch Timefold used to secure this round

**A note on sourcing:** Timefold's actual investor deck is not public. What follows is reconstructed entirely from the company's own press release, its CEO's and CTO's on-the-record quotes, its lead investor's public statement of what convinced them to lead the round, and its published customer results. Nothing here is invented — every line traces to one of the sources above — but it is a reconstruction of the narrative, not a leaked document.

### 1. The hook — "schedules run the world"

*"Schedules run the world. We are all at the mercy of a schedule, and so are the millions of frontline workers whose days depend on getting it right. As software becomes increasingly autonomous, optimization becomes foundational*

*infrastructure."*

— Maarten Vandenbroucke, CEO, Timefold — press release, June 23, 2026

The opening framing was never "we sell scheduling software." It was that scheduling is invisible, universal infrastructure — every technician dispatch, flight assignment, and shift roster runs through a schedule, and getting it wrong has a real cost. That's the category-size argument: not a niche vertical tool, a horizontal layer under all operational software.

## 2. The timing argument — why now

Timefold's public writing (its blog, its founders' quotes) leans hard on one specific timing thesis: the rise of AI-generated and AI-agentic software is creating a wave of new applications that need to make scheduling decisions, but large language models are probabilistic and unreliable at the kind of hard-constraint correctness a real shift roster or vehicle route requires. That gap — LLMs can talk about a schedule but can't reliably produce a valid one — is the wedge.

*"What matters in mission-critical scheduling isn't creativity, it's correctness: a shift roster or a vehicle route has to be right, compliant, and reproducible every time. LLMs aren't built for that."*

— Alexander Meyer-Scharenberg, Partner, Alstin Capital — Timefold press release

## 3. The moat — deterministic optimization wrapped as infrastructure

The product argument is that Timefold isn't starting from zero: its solver is built on OptaPlanner, an open-source constraint solver with 18 years of production use (created by co-founder Geoffrey De Smet, previously at Red Hat/IBM), now wrapped in modular, API-first products any enterprise engineering team can deploy without hiring operations-research mathematicians.

*"They've taken a battle-tested open source optimization engine and wrapped it in modular products that any enterprise can deploy, without needing a team of mathematicians. That's how deep optimization technology becomes infrastructure, and we believe Timefold is best placed to own that category."*

— Alexander Meyer-Scharenberg, Partner, Alstin Capital

*"Geoffrey's life's work has been to revolutionise how complex NP-hard problems are addressed, saving enterprises, governments, and infrastructure providers hundreds of millions of euros annually. For 18 years, his leading open-source technology has optimised critical operations, scheduling shifts for thousands of police officers, routing millions of parcels, assigning gates at major airports, and planning national train timetables."*

— Enrico Mellis, Principal, Lakestar — 2024 seed round quote

## 4. The proof — traction, not just theory

- 4x ARR growth in 2025 — the headline commercial metric in the round announcement.
- Quantified customer outcomes used as case-study proof: 33% less drive time, 43% less distance traveled, overtime eliminated entirely (real estate services customer); a scheduling process cut from 10 weeks to 10 minutes (retail staffing customer).
- A roster of recognizable enterprise logos across two very different sales motions — direct enterprise (CBRE, Lufthansa, Orange Telecom, Thales, Subaru, Deutsche Bahn) and embedded/OEM via software vendors and platforms (NEC Software Solutions, ADP, Palantir).

## 5. The vision close — category ownership

*"Our platform gives software builders the ability to embed enterprise-grade decision intelligence into their applications, enabling better outcomes for businesses, workers and customers alike."*

— Maarten Vandenbroucke, CEO, Timefold

The closing pitch line is explicitly a category-ownership claim: Timefold's stated ambition is to become "the default platform for building, deploying, and operating scheduling optimization models" as AI-generated software makes scheduling logic a default requirement of far more applications than build it today.

## Why this matters for TimeSpan

Timefold's funded narrative validates the market TimeSpan is building in — scheduling optimization as infrastructure, sold API-first with a tiered platform on top — and it also shows the specific proof points investors respond to: a quantified before/after customer result, a clear ARR growth multiple, and a determinism-vs-LLM framing that draws a sharp, defensible line around what the product does that generic AI cannot. TimeSpan's own gap-analysis report (delivered separately) shows where the platform already matches this playbook and where the remaining work — a public case study with a real quantified result, and a comparably crisp "why deterministic beats generative for this class of problem" narrative — would directly mirror what just got Timefold funded.